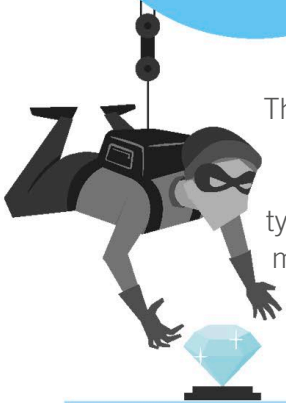


February

16



2003

Infamous heist

Thieves broke into the Antwerp Diamond Centre in Belgium, sneaked past 10 different types of security measure, and made off with US \$100 million of diamonds, gold, and jewellery.

Also on this day

1857 US Congress approved funding for the Columbia Institution for the Instruction of the Deaf and Dumb and the Blind. It was the first school for students with hearing, speech, and sight difficulties.

1933 The existence of a type of invisible material called dark matter was suggested by US astronomer Fritz Zwicky.

1945 The Alaska Equal Rights Act was signed in the USA to prevent discrimination against the Indigenous peoples of Alaska.

Tomb discovery

1923

When British archaeologist Howard Carter entered the burial chamber of Pharaoh Tutankhamun in Thebes, Egypt, he found ancient treasures, undisturbed since 1324 BCE. As well as the mummy of the boy king inside a gold coffin, there were clothes, jewellery, games, and food for the afterlife.

1946

Chopper takes flight

The Sikorsky S-51 took off on its first test flight. It was used as a communication and evacuation helicopter by the US Air Force, and was also the first helicopter to be used by private companies.



Born this day

1973 Cathy Freeman, Indigenous Australian sprinter. Among the First Australians, she was the first to win gold at the Commonwealth Games and gold in an Olympic solo event.

